

different skills and strengths, it is worthwhile to decide upon a career path that allows you to use your talents to the best of your ability.

Although we can argue that no job skill should be worth more than another, the fact remains that a doctor's skills are more highly compensated than a teacher's. If you find that the job of your dreams does not pay well, that fact should not detract you from pursuing it. When people decide upon professions solely for the financial reward, they often find themselves miserable in a job for which they feel no passion.

Once you have answered the difficult question "What do you want to be when you grow up?" you then need to do some research. Find the answers to the following questions:

- How much education is necessary for this profession?
- Do you need an advanced degree?
- How much will this education cost you?
- How much can you expect to earn?

Joan had decided upon her profession when she was a little girl. She always interviewed everyone around her. Joan loved to ask questions and had an inquisitive mind. She became the editor of her high school newspaper and was responsible for the paper winning several awards. It was therefore no great surprise to her parents when she decided to become a journalist.

She enrolled in Northwestern University's school of journalism and graduated near the top of her class. Upon graduation, at twenty-four, she started working as a reporter for a local newspaper in a Los Angeles suburb. Unfortunately, this dream job did not offer a dream salary. She made only \$28,000 a year. Joan found it very difficult to survive on this salary in a

